

[REDACTED] 1/4

From: [REDACTED] >
Sent: Friday, September 25, 2020 2:15 PM
To: [REDACTED]
Subject: Re: Photo for analysis

Dear [REDACTED]/Steve

Definitely American. European physician photos are posed, dressed and arranged differently. I even have a collection of Russian medical images and none of the images have the informality American images have.
The other thing to consider if it is a 1940s image is radiation damage to an animal - a primate.

best
Stanley B Burns, MD
[REDACTED]

On Sep 25, 2020, at 2:04 PM, <[REDACTED]> wrote:

Dear Dr. [REDACTED]

Steve definitely enjoyed your conversation as did I as I was there most of the time.
One last questionDo you have an opinion on whether the gentlemen in the photo are European or American? Or the equipment European or American?

Also, please let me know the address for the check and who it should be made out to.

We look forward to watching the documentary about the Lincoln photo.

Best wishes,
[REDACTED]

From: [REDACTED] >
Sent: Friday, September 25, 2020 1:59 PM
To: [REDACTED]
Subject: Re: Photo for analysis

Dear Dr Greer

Great talking to you. As regards this photograph—I compared it to many other dissection and autopsy photographs taken during the first half of the twentieth century. I have concluded this image is from the 1925-1930 time period. It may be a medical post-graduate medical scene as the men around the table do not appear to be young students that one would expect in a typical medical school anatomy class dissection scene. Dissection scenes were still popular at the time. The dress clothes and mannerisms indicate several senior physicians are present. The men in street clothes in the back are an indication that the dissection or autopsy was a significant event as observers were never present in classic dissection scenes. Police or other officials sometimes observed the body or an autopsy of noted criminals such as Pretty Boy Floyd or John Dillinger -this was very common. The men in the back are a

significant aspect of the important of this photograph and may lead to proper identification of the event.

One major problem in positively dating is the format of the photograph— Is it a color process photograph which would be common in the 1940s or is it a 1920s black and white photograph which has been painted. Painting photographs was common in that time period as well as the 1940. I see its not an original but a copy print image of a picture- you can see the outlines of the original print.. The copied photograph may have been painted ?? You really have some puzzling and questionable aspects of this image.

My 2015 text, *Stiffs, Skulls and Skeleton: Medical Photography and Symbolism* reviews the subject of physicians posing with bodies or body parts. Currently I am working on a second volume of the history of painting photographs.

As you are tracking down the authenticity of an unusual photograph you may enjoy watching a Discovery Channel documentary (airs October 6th) that I participated in- identification and analysis of an amazing unknown photograph of Abraham Lincoln- taken on his deathbed-- here's the URL to the promo which I am featured in.

<https://www.discovery.com/dnews/long-lost-photo-of-abraham-lincoln-on-deathbed-featured-in-new-d>

You may see my latest books and material of interest on my website www.burnsarchive.com.

Please keep me in the loop about the progress of discoveries about this image.

best

[REDACTED] ID, FACS

President The [REDACTED] Archive & Collection
Research Professor of Medicine and Psychiatry
Professor of Medical Humanities
Adjunct Professor of Obstetrics and Gynecology
New York University Langone Health and medical School



On Sep 24, 2020, at 12:19 PM, [REDACTED] wrote:

Dear Dr. Burns,

This is a much clearer picture of the event, but with the body removed.

I will share what you mention below with my husband as perhaps that is the case.

It's the time frame of when the event might have taken place that is our main interest.

Yes, it was a picture or a picture that fell out of a book that belonged to his woman's grandmother.

Thanks so much.



From: [REDACTED]
Sent: Thursday, September 24, 2020 11:11 AM
To: [REDACTED]
Subject: Re: Photo for analysis

If its an autopsy it is very rare --of the 20,000 or more images I have seen of bodies on tables surrounded by doctors only about a dozen were autopsies. The rest were the traditional cadaver dissection scenes common to medical establishments. Because they are all older men I would say without seeing the body its a post-graduate dissection- Also the fact it was found in a book. Autopsy scenes were often framed. just by sheer numbers --when I hear hoof steps in NYCity I don't think of Zebras.
S

On Sep 24, 2020, at 10:38 AM, [REDACTED] wrote:

Thank you so much for the quick reply, [REDACTED]
Yes, \$75 is fine and finishing up tomorrow would be excellent.

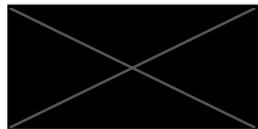
This photo was shown to us by a woman who found it in a book in items stored from her grandmother's possessions.
If you could see the body you would know it was an autopsy.
I realized the person who blurred the body for us also blurred the bowl that was in the original.
I'm hoping you may be able to date it from what you can see but if the bowl is essential I can see if the blurring can be more precise.

From some research we have done we have found out that the photo is actually a photo of a photo, but it's the closest to the original we have.
Sincerely

[REDACTED]

From: [REDACTED]@[REDACTED]>
Sent: Thursday, September 24, 2020 10:33 AM
To: [REDACTED]
Cc: [REDACTED]
Subject: Re: Photo for analysis

Hi
For this image we would charge \$75.00 for identification. All booked up today so will finish tomorrow. But I do need some help from you>
The first and most important question. IS ---why do you call this an autopsy. Since I cant see the body and doctors action. I cant tell. Do you have positive written documentation it is an autopsy?? Where was this image from, from a frame, album or just a one off found image
[REDACTED]



1/4

On Sep 24, 2020, at 10:08 AM, <[REDACTED]>
<[REDACTED]> wrote:

Dear Mr. [REDACTED]

Yesterday, I think, you spoke with my colleague, Pat Pearsall.

My husband asked me to forward the photo in question to you.

It is an autopsy but we have blurred out the body for privacy reasons.

My husband would like if possible for you to date/ date range:

- The table they are using
- The bowl
- The gloves
- The aprons/lab coats.

And we would welcome any other information that might help us identify the time frame of the picture.

Thank you so much for your help.

Please let me know how much it will be and how long it will take.

I have meetings all day today (Thursday) but will check my computer when I can.

My cell is: [REDACTED]

Sincerely,

[REDACTED]

<blurred body.JPG>

<body removed.jpg>